

IT.com in the IT Capital

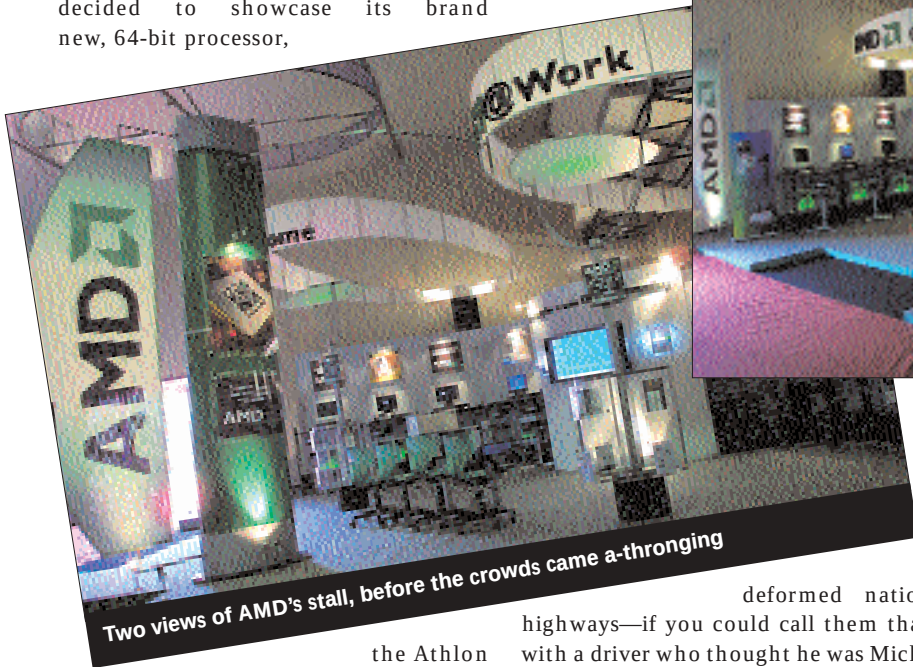
Bangalore! A city of night pubs, bountiful gardens, cool climate, the Anil Kumble Circle, and crazy motorists on two wheelers. Not to mention, the venue of IT.com 2003, India's largest industry expo featuring the who's who of the IT scene, held from the November 1 to November 5 this year.

It was at this event that AMD decided to showcase its brand new, 64-bit processor,

and SKOAR! Magazine?

So off we went to IT.com. Badri and Ahmed represented the editorial team, while Bhavesh, Nabjeet and Raju composed the marketing team. After a gruelling 22-hour bus journey over our great

After accomplishing their mission for the night, the famous five headed back to the local home base—the company guest house—to prepare for a bright and early start the next day.



Two views of AMD's stall, before the crowds came a-thronging

the Athlon 64 FX. AMD planned to include a network of PCs that would host the latest multiplayer games for some great group deathmatching. And who better to conduct this gaming session than Digit

deformed national highways—if you could call them that—with a driver who thought he was Michael Schumacher in the last race of the championship, our visibly shaken group finally landed in Bangalore on the evening of October 31, and headed straight for the venue—things needed to be set up ASAP.



From left to right: Nabjeet, Raju, Ahmed, Badri, and Bhavesh

It was a bright and cool Saturday that saw the event being thrown open. After the inauguration, people started to stream into the stall, where Unreal Tournament 2003 had been set up. The main attractions? Multiplayer tournaments with Digit and SKOAR! Magazines as prizes, a massive plasma screen that was playing various game videos, and of course, a couple of shiny-silvery models all dressed up in AMD's corporate colours.

The first two days, Badri was practically deluged by a flood of interested people who wanted a go at the game, attempt to win the prizes on offer, and if they failed to do so, pester Raju for hours in an attempt to get a free copy of Digit. No one expected to see such large crowds with such great enthusiasm. Calling our boys unprepared would be making an understatement. One thing was for sure: if you happened to be agoraphobic, IT.com was not the place to be.

With so many PC enthusiasts at the Palace grounds, we came across busloads of Digit and SKOAR! readers. There was plenty of interaction to be had, and even more viewpoints to share. IT.com presented us the perfect opportunity to meet readers we usually only think of in the abstract. Many thanks to all of you who visited us, we look forward to meeting you again next year! ■